



User Manual

Chords, scales and melody in one progression workspace

Version 1.0 · Windows

1. Welcome

Gavna Music Composer is a workspace for writing chord progressions. Chords, scales and melody live together in the same eight **slots**, so you can hear a progression, see which scales fit it and sketch a melody over it on one screen — and then take the result to your DAW as MIDI.

This manual walks through every part of the app. You don't need to read it all at once: sections 2 and 3 are enough to start.

Free trial and license. Gavna Music Composer runs free for 15 days. After that it needs a license key: **Help** → **Buy or Activate Gavna Music Composer...** opens the license window, where **Buy it** takes you to the purchase page (a single payment, no subscription) and the key you receive by email goes in the field below it. Activating needs an internet connection once; after that Gavna Music Composer works offline. **Deactivate on this computer**, in the same window, frees the activation so you can use your key on another computer.

2. The screen at a glance



The top bar, the module tabs and the Memory Bank.

- **Top bar** — Open Project, Open Last, Save, Save As; the **AUDIO** light (red = sound on; click to mute); Undo and Redo.
- **Module tabs** — Keyboard, Chord Module, Scale Module, Library and Progression Module. Clicking a tab brings that module up right under the Memory Bank. You can also drag a tab, or a module's header, to reorder the modules.
- **Memory Bank** — always at the top: your eight slots.
- **Modules** — below it. The arrow at the right of each module's title collapses or expands it. The Memory Bank is fixed: it always stays open.

3. Memory Bank

The Memory Bank holds your progression: eight slots, one bar each, played from left to right.



Each slot: layer icons, screen and piano roll.

Adding a chord

- **Type it** in an empty slot's field — *Dm7*, *Cmaj7*, *F#m7b5*... — and press Enter.
- **Pick it** in the Library, the Keyboard's "Possible chords" or the Chord Module (sections 4–7).
- **Drag it** from any of those onto a slot.

Anatomy of a slot

- **Layer icons** — red: chord, purple: scale, cyan: melody. Click one to hide or show that layer in this slot; **Alt + click** does it in every slot at once; **Ctrl + click** clears that layer — the chord, the scale or the melody — from this slot, leaving the other two as they are (Ctrl + Z brings it back). Hidden layers are neither played nor exported. The X clears the slot.
- **Screen** — the chord's name, the scale laid over it (if any), the slot number and, if it isn't 4/4, its time signature.
- **Piano roll** — three octaves (C3–B5). Red bars are the chord's notes, purple ones the scale, cyan blocks the melody. A chord placed over a melody goes to the melody's octave; **Ctrl + drag** its red bars up or down to move it by octaves (it plays where it's drawn).
- **+ under the slots** adds a second row, slots 9–16, and every Progression Module group gets 8 more slots too; the **–** under the second row minimizes it: what's in slots 9–16 is kept, inactive (not shown, played or exported), and the next **+** shows it again. **Clear**, next to it, empties that minimized row for good (Ctrl + Z brings it back). **Edit** → **Preferences** → **Slots in New Projects** makes new projects start with 8 or 16.
- **4 | 8** — the melody grid under the roll: quarter notes or eighth notes (twice as many steps in any time signature: 3 | 6 in 3/4). Ctrl + click sets every slot. **Edit** → **Preferences** → **Melody Grid for New**

Slots chooses which one new slots start with.

- **Alt + mouse wheel** over a slot lifts it out as a floating window that grows with each notch, to see and edit its melody more comfortably; wheel down shrinks it back. Its **×** becomes a minimize key — that or **Esc** puts it back.

Selecting slots

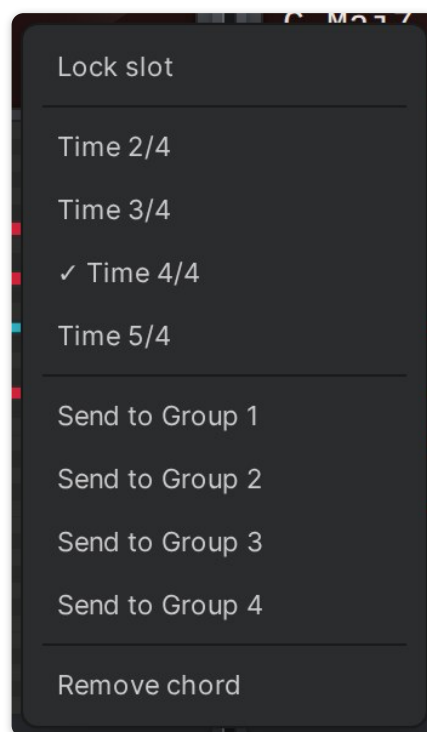
Click a slot to select it and hear it: its chord and, if it has one, its melody, as one bar at the current tempo (each layer only if its icon is showing). **Shift + click** selects a range; **Ctrl + click** adds or removes a single slot. Keys **1 – 8** select a slot from the keyboard. A click on empty space in the window (the background, a panel's background, the gap between slots) clears the selection.

Writing a melody

Select a slot, then click in its piano roll to place a note — one note per beat. Drag a note to move it; select it and press **Delete** to remove it, or use the **arrow keys** to move it.

The slot's right-click menu

- **Lock slot** — a locked slot can't be changed, cleared, moved or transposed until you unlock it (also **Ctrl + L**).
- **Time 2/4 – 5/4** — the slot's own time signature.
- **Send to Group 1–4** — copies the slot (or the selected slots) into the Progression Module. An empty slot that is part of the selection opens this menu too, and goes along as a silent bar.
- **Clear scale overlay** and **Remove chord**.

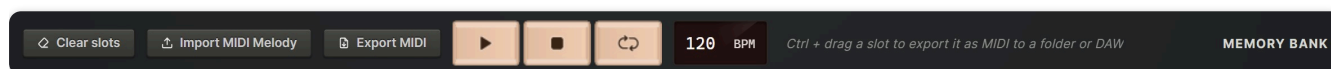


Right-click on a slot.

Moving, copying and clearing

Drag a slot onto another to move it (a multi-selection moves as a block). **Ctrl + C** / **Ctrl + V** / **Ctrl + X** copy, paste and cut slots, **Ctrl + D** duplicates them, **Delete** clears them, and **Clear slots** empties the whole bank except locked slots.

Playback and tempo



Play / Stop / Loop, the BPM screen and the Ctrl + drag reminder.

Play (or the Space bar) plays the filled slots back to back, chords and melody, on the grand piano; empty slots between filled ones are rests, and empty slots before the first and after the last are not played. **Ctrl + Play** (or Ctrl + Space) plays only the selected slots. The screen of the slot being heard lights up. **Loop** (the button next to Stop, or the R key) makes the bank start over, with no gap, when the last slot ends, until you press Stop (if nothing was playing, it also starts playback); change a chord while it plays and you hear it on the next time round. Turn it off while playing and the current pass finishes, then stops. The **BPM screen** sets the tempo from 30 to 300: drag up or down on it (hold Shift for fine steps), or double-click it and type a value. New projects start at 120 BPM; a saved project remembers its own tempo.

MIDI in and out

- **Import MIDI Melody** — reads a MIDI file and places its bars as the melody of the slots, one bar per slot; a melody longer than 8 bars opens slots 9–16. The melody moves by whole octaves so it sits as close to the middle of the roll as it fits (a toast says when it was moved). Chords stay as they are.
- **Export MIDI** — saves the bank (or the selected slots) as a MIDI file, with chords and melody on separate tracks, at the current tempo.
- **Ctrl + drag** — hold Ctrl and drag a slot (or a selection) out of Gavna Music Composer into a folder or straight onto a track in your DAW: it drops as a *.mid* file with exactly the layers the slot shows. A plain drag, without Ctrl, moves things inside Gavna Music Composer.

4. Keyboard



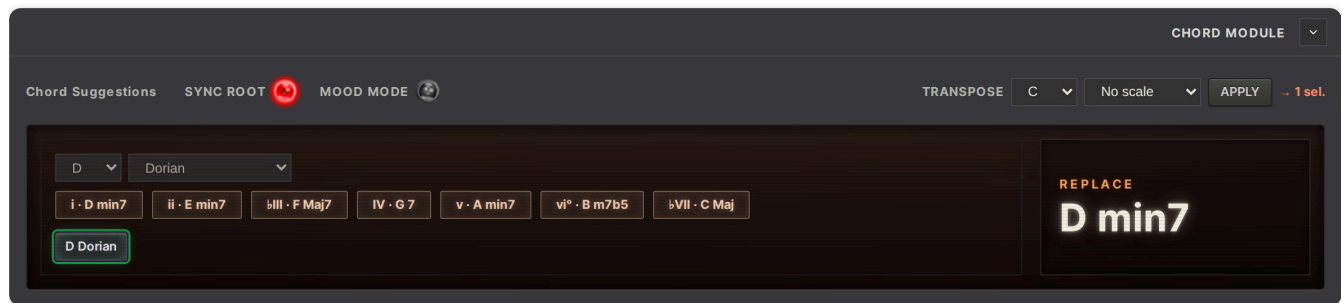
Notes in red form an exact chord; in cyan they don't.

Click keys to add or remove notes (you'll hear each one); drag across the keys to add several; right-click a key to remove it. **Ctrl + click** on any key plays every note entered so far, together, without changing anything. While the selected notes form an exact chord they turn **red**; otherwise they are **cyan**.

Possible chords lists every chord that contains your notes; with **Strict** on, only the chords made of exactly those notes. Narrow the list with **Search**, **All Roots** and **All Chord Types**. Click a chord to add it

to the Memory Bank, right-click to hear it — or use **Send to MEMORY BANK** to send the notes as they are. **CLEAR** removes the selection.

5. Chord Module



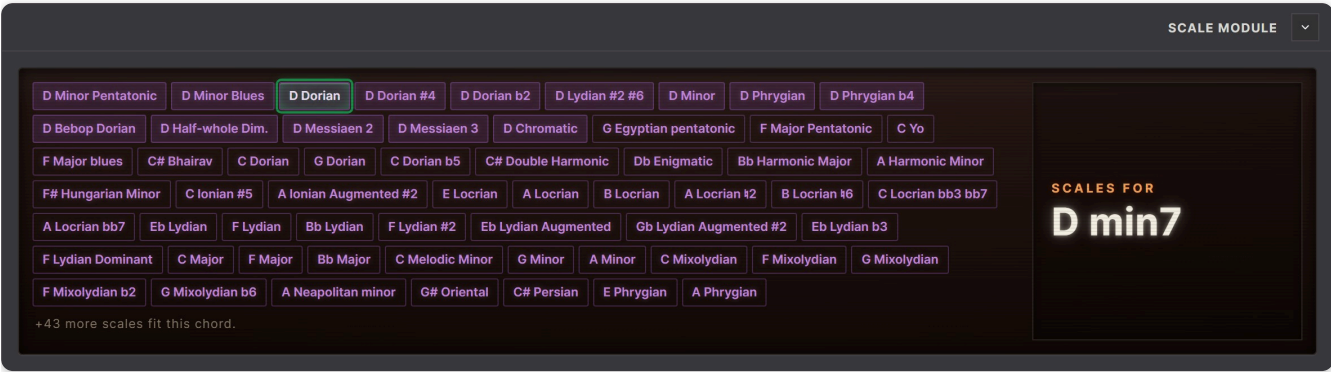
Suggestions for the selected chord, and Transpose.

The Chord Module works on the chord selected in the Memory Bank. The box on the right says what a suggestion will do: **Replace** the selected chord, or go **After** the last one (or into the empty slot you selected).

- **SYNC ROOT** (on) — shows the chords of the mode whose tonic chord is the selected one, with their degree (i, ii, IV...): a major chord reads as its major key, a minor chord as its minor key, G7 as G Mixolydian, Bm7b5 as B Locrian, a diminished 7th as the harmonic minor a half step above it — and a chord you laid a mode over (D Dorian on Dm7) reads as that mode. Turn it off to choose the root and mode yourself; a degree whose scale notes stack into no chord (in some exotic scales) shows none.
- **MOOD MODE** — ranks chords on every root by how well they continue the music, in the key of the whole Memory Bank: dominants resolve where they lead (V7 to I, vii° up a half step, a tritone substitute down a half step), V to vi is the deceptive cadence, and the rest follows the classic table of root progressions. With a chord selected, it ranks what best *replaces* it between its neighbours. Filter by mood — happy, hopeful, static, bright, melancholic, dark, tense, anger, mysterious — or *bridge*, chords outside the key with no recognizable job. Each chord's tooltip names its chromatic function when it has one: secondary dominant, leading-tone diminished, tritone substitute, Neapolitan, modal interchange.
- **Melody-based** — when the selected slot has a melody and no chord, the module harmonizes it the way it is taught: the notes on strong beats and the long notes belong to the chord, the others may pass through it; chords in the key come first.

Click a suggestion to place it; right-click to hear it first. **TRANPOSE** works on the whole bank or just the selected slots; locked slots stay put. **With no scale**, it moves everything by the same number of semitones to the new root: every chord keeps its intervals, the melody its contour and each slot its scale. **With a scale**, it takes the progression from its key to the chosen one **degree by degree** (diatonic transposition): from C major to A minor, I–vi–IV–V becomes i–VI–iv–V (Am F Dm E). Each chord becomes the new key's chord on the same degree, just as rich (a triad stays a triad, a 7th chord keeps its 7th); a borrowed chord keeps its relation to the tonic; the melody moves by scale degree, and a slot's scale becomes the matching mode. **Ctrl + ↑ / ↓** transposes by one semitone, like **TRANPOSE** with no scale.

6. Scale Module



Every scale that contains the selected chord.

Lists every scale (out of 73) that contains the chord selected in the Memory Bank; bright ones share its root. Click a scale — or drag it onto a slot — to lay it over that chord as purple notes in the piano roll. Remove it from the slot's right-click menu.

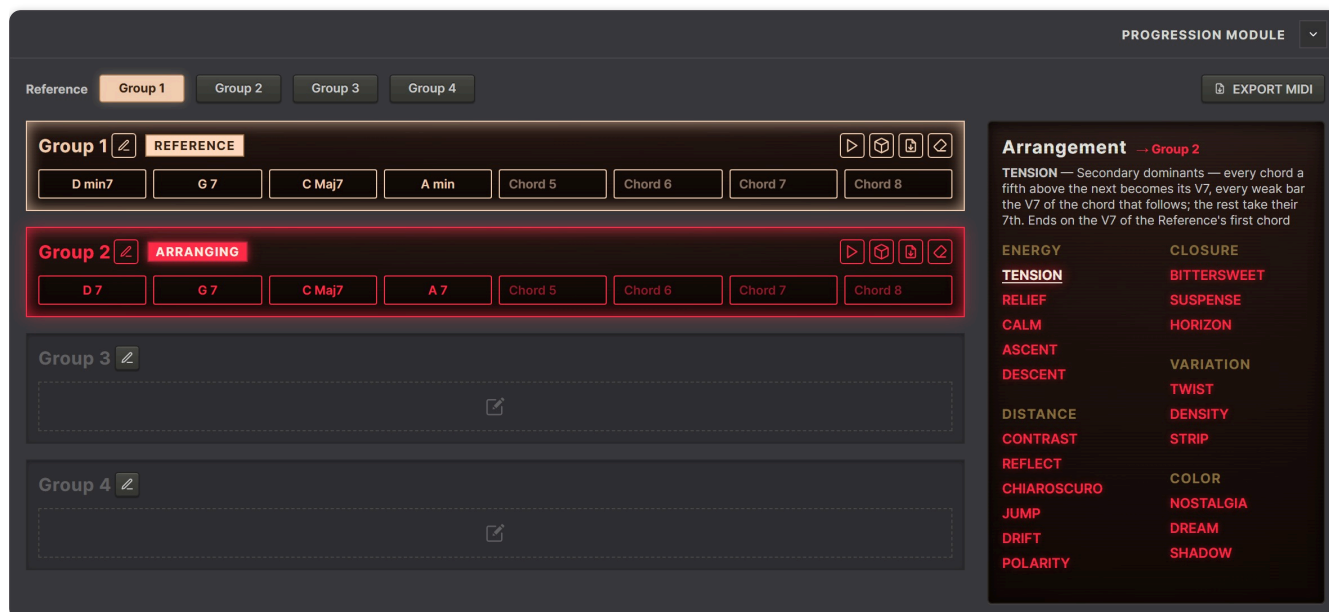
7. Library



Pick a root, then a chord type.

All 44 chord types in every key. Choose a root in the top row, then click a chord to add it to the Memory Bank (into the selected slot, or the first free one), right-click to hear it, or drag it onto a slot.

8. Progression Module



Four groups, the Reference and the arrangement techniques.

Four groups of eight chords for building sections or variations of a song.

- **Filling a group** — type chords into its fields, drop chords from the Memory Bank or the Library, or use *Send to Group* from a slot's right-click menu.
- **Reference** — the group every arrangement starts from; choose it with the buttons at the top left.
- **Arranging** — the group the techniques write into. Click an empty (grey) group to make it the target.
- **Techniques** — 20, in five families: **Energy** (Tension, Relief, Calm, Ascent, Descent), **Distance** (Contrast, Reflect, Chiaroscuro, Jump, Drift, Polarity), **Closure** (Bittersweet, Suspense, Horizon), **Variation** (Twist, Density, Strip) and **Color** (Nostalgia, Dream, Shadow). Point at one to read what it does. Each rebuilds from the Reference, so trying another never stacks on the last. The result follows the Reference's shape: a bar left empty there stays empty, and each chord keeps the time signature (4/4, 3/4...) of its place. Every technique reworks the whole progression, bar by bar, with a named theory concept (secondary dominants, plagal reharmonization, negative harmony, modal mixture...), and never repeats a chord in two bars running where the Reference moves on; only the **Closure** family changes just the ending, because a cadence is the end of a phrase.
- **Group icons** — play the group (while it plays, Play turns into Stop and its background gently pulses, and the chord being heard lights up; Space and the Memory Bank's Stop also stop it), send it to the Memory Bank, export it as MIDI, clear it. The pencil renames it.
- **Chords in a group** — click to select, double-click to edit, right-click to hear, Delete to remove.
- **Ctrl + drag** a chord to export that chord, or anywhere else on the group to export the whole group. **EXPORT MIDI** (top right) exports every chord of every group.

9. Projects and preferences

- **Save / Save As** store everything — Memory Bank, Progression Module and tempo — as a project file (.json). **Open Project**, **Open Last** and **File** → **Open Recent** bring it back.
- If you close with unsaved changes, Gavna Music Composer asks whether to save them.

- **Edit → Preferences: Resume Last Session on Startup** reopens your last project and module order; **Language** switches between English and Español instantly; **Note Names** chooses American (C D E) or Latin (Do Re Mi) — also in the View menu. Either way, every note is spelled for its key: the Memory Bank and each Progression Module group use their own (Eb in C minor, D# in E major; borrowed chords with flats, leading tones with sharps), and where there is no key — the Library, the Keyboard — as lead sheets write chord roots: C# Eb F# Ab Bb. **When Closing with Unsaved Changes** is Ask Every Time, Save Without Asking or Close Without Saving — ticking **Don't ask again** on that question sets it. **Reset All Preferences...** puts every option back to how a fresh install starts (the question on close comes back).

10. Keyboard shortcuts

Ctrl + N / O / S	New / Open / Save project
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save As
Ctrl + Space	Play only the selected slots
Ctrl + click on the Keyboard	Hear the notes entered on the Keyboard
Alt + mouse wheel	Enlarge a slot as a floating window (Esc puts it back)
Ctrl + drag red bars	Move a slot's chord an octave up / down
Ctrl + I / Ctrl + E	Import MIDI melody / Export MIDI
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / Redo
Ctrl + C / V / X	Copy / paste / cut selected slots
Ctrl + A / Ctrl + D	Select all slots / deselect everything
Ctrl + Shift + D	Duplicate selected slots
Delete	Clear selected slots (or the selected melody note)
Space	Play / Stop
R	Loop playback on / off
1 – 8	Select a Memory Bank slot
Ctrl + ↑ / ↓	Transpose one semitone
Ctrl + L	Lock / unlock selected slots
Arrow keys	Move the selected melody note
Shift + click / Ctrl + click	Select several slots
Drag / Ctrl + drag	Move inside Gavna Music Composer / export as .mid to a folder or DAW
F11 / Esc	Full screen / leave full screen

11. Tips and troubleshooting

- **No sound?** Check that the AUDIO light is red and your system volume is up. The piano loads in the background the first moments after start; until then a simpler sound plays.
- **"That slot is locked"** — right-click the slot and choose Unlock, or press Ctrl + L.
- **A drag doesn't reach your DAW?** Make sure you hold Ctrl from the start of the drag.
- **Help → Keyboard Shortcuts** shows the shortcut list at any time.
- **The license key won't activate?** Copy it straight from the purchase email, with no spaces around it. If it says the key is active on the maximum number of computers, deactivate it on one of them first (Help → Gavna Music Composer License...).

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Piano samples: Salamander Grand Piano by Alexander Holm (CC BY 3.0)